

HEALTHY LIFESTYLE FOR GENERATION Z STUDENTS

SOCIETAL IMMERSION PROGRAMME REPORT

MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

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JAMAL INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT

(Approved by AICTE, New Delhi)

JAMAL MOHAMED COLLEGE (Autonomous)

Accredited with A++ Grade by NAAC (4th Cycle) with CGPA 3.69 out of 4.0

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TIRUCHIRAPPALLI - 620 020

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the Societal Immersion Programme report titled “**HEALTHY LIFESTYLE FOR GENERATION Z STUDENTS**” is a bonafide record of the work carried out by

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in partial fulfillment of the requirement for the award of the degree of **MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION**, submitted to Jamal Institute of Management, Jamal Mohamed College (Autonomous), Tiruchirappalli, during the academic year 2026 - 2027.

GUIDE

DIRECTOR

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CHAPTER 1 – INTRODUCTION

1.1 INTRODUCTION:

Generation Z—typically defined as those born between the mid-1990s and early 2010s—is growing up in a world that is more connected, fast-paced, and digitally saturated than any before it. For students in this generation, especially in India, daily life is shaped by academic pressure, social media influence, and constant exposure to information, all of which have a direct impact on their physical and mental well-being. They are the first generation to have grown up entirely in the digital age, where smartphones, social media platforms, and instant communication are not luxuries but essential parts of everyday existence. From attending online classes to submitting assignments, from staying in touch with friends to seeking entertainment, almost every aspect of a Gen Z student’s life is mediated through screens.

In recent years, there has been a noticeable shift in how young people think about health. While earlier generations often equated “being healthy” with just the absence of illness, Gen Z students increasingly see health as a holistic balance of physical fitness, mental wellness, nutrition, sleep, and even digital habits. Surveys show that a large proportion of Indian Gen Z students now prioritise both physical and mental health, with many actively using apps, wearables, and online resources to track steps, sleep, mood, and stress levels. This generation is more open to discussing mental health, seeking support, and challenging traditional stigmas surrounding emotional well-being. Terms like “self-care,” “burnout,” “anxiety,” and “mindfulness” have become part of everyday conversations among young people, reflecting a growing awareness that health is not only about the body but also about the mind and emotions.

At the same time, this generation also faces unique challenges. Long hours of screen time, irregular sleep patterns, reliance on junk food, and high levels of stress and anxiety are becoming common among college and school students. Studies indicate that issues like low mood, loneliness, burnout, and trouble sleeping are frequently reported by Gen Z students in India, even as many remain hesitant to seek professional help. Nearly half of Gen Z individuals in India report facing anxiety or stress, with academic pressure, career uncertainty, and social expectations cited as major contributors. The paradox is clear: while awareness about health is higher than ever, actual lifestyle practices often fall short of ideal standards. Many students know what they *should* do—sleep earlier, exercise more, eat better—but find it difficult to translate that knowledge into consistent action.

The social project “**Healthy Lifestyle for Generation Z Students**” is designed to address these realities in a human, relatable way. Rather than presenting health as a strict set of rules, this initiative aims to understand the everyday struggles, habits, and aspirations of Gen Z students and to co-create practical, sustainable lifestyle changes with them. The focus is not on perfection, but on small, consistent steps—

such as better sleep routines, mindful use of technology, balanced nutrition, regular movement, and open conversations about mental health—that can collectively lead to a healthier, more balanced life.

The project recognises that lasting change does not come from guilt or pressure but from empathy, understanding, and support.

For many students, the idea of a “healthy lifestyle” can feel overwhelming. Between assignments, exams, part-time work, family responsibilities, and social commitments, finding time for exercise, home-cooked meals, or adequate sleep often seems unrealistic. Social media adds another layer of complexity: while it can inspire positive change through fitness trends and wellness content, it can also create pressure, comparison, and information overload. A student may scroll through posts of peers working out at the gym, eating carefully planned meals, or meditating every morning, and feel inadequate about their own habits. This project recognises these tensions and seeks to work *with* students, not *at* them, by listening to their experiences and building solutions that fit into their real lives. It acknowledges that a student staying up late to complete an assignment is not lazy but burdened, and that a student relying on instant food is not careless but constrained by time and resources.

In the Indian context, Generation Z students are navigating a particularly complex environment. On one hand, there is strong emphasis on academic achievement, competitive exams, and securing stable careers in a rapidly changing job market. On the other hand, they are exposed to global trends in fitness, mental health awareness, and self-care through digital platforms. This creates a unique tension: many students want to be healthier and more balanced, but they often lack the time, guidance, or supportive structures to make lasting changes. The pressure to perform academically often comes at the cost of self-care, with students sacrificing sleep, physical activity, and proper nutrition in favour of studying longer hours. In many families, discussions about mental health are still taboo, and seeking help from a counsellor or therapist may be viewed as a sign of weakness rather than strength. This project seeks to challenge such notions by normalising conversations about well-being and presenting health as a foundation for success, not a distraction from it.

The COVID-19 pandemic further disrupted routines for this generation. Extended periods of online classes, reduced physical activity, increased screen time, and social isolation have left lasting effects on sleep patterns, fitness levels, and emotional well-being. Many students developed habits during the pandemic—such as staying up late, skipping meals, or spending excessive time on social media—that have persisted even after returning to offline classes. Even as offline classes have resumed, many students continue to struggle with irregular schedules, procrastination, and difficulty in rebuilding healthy habits. This project therefore emerges at a critical time, when intentional efforts are needed to help young people reset their lifestyle patterns and develop resilience for future challenges. The pandemic also highlighted the

importance of mental health, as students dealt with uncertainty, loss, and isolation, making it clear that emotional well-being is as important as physical health.

Another important dimension is the role of technology in the lives of Gen Z students. Smartphones and social media are not just tools; they are central to how this generation studies, socialises, entertains itself, and even defines its identity. While technology offers undeniable benefits—such as access to information, online support communities, and health-tracking apps—it can also contribute to overuse, distraction, sleep disruption, and feelings of inadequacy. Many students report using their phones late into the night, which affects their sleep quality and leaves them feeling tired and unfocused the next day. Social media platforms, while connecting people, can also create unrealistic expectations about body image, productivity, and lifestyle, leading to stress and low self-esteem. Understanding how students themselves perceive their relationship with technology is essential for designing realistic health interventions that do not simply demonise screens but promote mindful and balanced use. The goal is not to eliminate technology but to help students use it in ways that support rather than undermine their well-being.

Mental and emotional well-being is another core focus of this project. For many students, stress is no longer an occasional experience but a constant background condition, driven by academic deadlines, uncertainty about the future, financial concerns, and social pressures. While awareness about mental health is growing, there remains a gap between knowing that support exists and actually accessing it. Factors such as stigma, lack of confidential services, cost, and limited awareness of available resources often prevent students from seeking help. Many students cope with stress through methods that may not be entirely healthy, such as excessive screen time, junk food, or withdrawal from social interactions. By including questions on stress, coping mechanisms, and willingness to discuss emotional problems, this project seeks to highlight both the challenges and the opportunities for strengthening mental health support for Gen Z students. It aims to create a safe space where students feel comfortable sharing their struggles and exploring healthier ways of managing stress.

This social project is also grounded in the belief that sustainable change comes from within the community. Rather than imposing external solutions, it aims to amplify the voices of students themselves. The questionnaire includes open-ended questions that invite students to share what they consider the most important healthy habit, what barriers they face, and what suggestions they have for institutions and peers. These responses are valuable not only as data but as authentic expressions of how young people understand and experience health in their own words. Incorporating these perspectives ensures that the recommendations emerging from this project are relevant, respectful, and realistic. When students feel heard and involved, they are more likely to take ownership of their health and support each other in making positive changes.

Finally, the project recognises that “healthy lifestyle” is not a one-size-fits-all concept. What works for one student may not work for another due to differences in schedule, resources, cultural background, or personal preferences. Therefore, the emphasis is on offering a range of options—small adjustments in sleep hygiene, simple physical activities that can be done at home or in hostels, affordable and culturally appropriate food choices, practical stress-management techniques, and strategies for managing screen time—so that each student can find what fits their life. The goal is progress, not perfection; consistency, not intensity. A student who adds one extra glass of water to their day, walks for ten minutes, or goes to bed thirty minutes earlier is making meaningful progress, even if they are not following a strict fitness regimen.

By combining research, reflection, and action, this project aspires to contribute to a broader movement that places student well-being at the centre of educational and social priorities. It is hoped that the insights and recommendations presented in this report will not only serve as an academic document but also as a practical guide for students, educators, and institutions committed to nurturing a healthier, more resilient Generation Z. The project is not just about collecting data or writing a report; it is about starting a conversation, raising awareness, and inspiring small but meaningful changes that can have a lasting impact on the lives of young people.

1.2 NEED AND SIGNIFICANCE OF THE STUDY:

Generation Z students are growing up in a world that is highly connected, competitive, and fast-paced. While this brings many opportunities, it also creates new challenges for their physical and mental health. Long hours of studying, heavy use of smartphones and social media, irregular sleep patterns, and dependence on junk food have become common among young people today.

Recent studies in India show that a large number of young people experience high levels of stress, anxiety, and poor sleep, often linked to academic pressure and constant digital exposure. At the same time, many Gen Z students are aware of the importance of health but struggle to translate that awareness into daily habits because of time constraints, lack of guidance, and social influences. This gap between awareness and action highlights the need for targeted interventions that support students in making sustainable lifestyle changes.

In this context, a social project focused on “Healthy Lifestyle for Generation Z Students” is highly relevant. It helps to:

- Bring attention to the real-life health challenges faced by students.
- Create a safe space for students to reflect on their own habits without feeling judged.

- Encourage small, practical changes in daily routines that can lead to long-term benefits.

Beyond individual students, this project also holds significance for **educational institutions**. Schools and colleges play a critical role in shaping the environment in which students live and learn. By understanding the lifestyle patterns and barriers faced by Gen Z students, institutions can design targeted wellness programmes, integrate mental health support into student services, and create policies that promote balanced routines (e.g., reasonable assignment deadlines, physical activity breaks, healthy food options in canteens). This project provides evidence-based insights that can guide such institutional improvements.

The project also has broader implications for **society and public health**. Healthy lifestyle habits formed during youth often persist into adulthood. By supporting Gen Z students in developing better sleep, nutrition, physical activity, and stress-management practices, this project contributes to long-term reductions in lifestyle-related diseases such as obesity, diabetes, cardiovascular conditions, and mental health disorders. Investing in youth health today can reduce the future healthcare burden and improve overall productivity and well-being in society.

Furthermore, this project aligns with **national priorities and initiatives** related to health and well-being. Government programmes such as **Fit India Movement**, **National Mental Health Programme**, and various state-level youth wellness initiatives emphasise the importance of physical activity, mental health awareness, and healthy lifestyle promotion among young people. By focusing on Generation Z students, this social project supports these broader national goals and contributes to the collective effort to build a healthier, more resilient youth population.

Finally, the project is significant because it **centres the voices of students themselves**. Rather than imposing external solutions, it seeks to understand students' own perceptions, challenges, and suggestions through a structured questionnaire. This participatory approach ensures that the recommendations emerging from the project are relevant, respectful, and realistic. When students feel heard and involved, they are more likely to take ownership of their health and support each other in making positive changes.

In summary, the need for this study arises from the growing health challenges faced by Generation Z students, the gap between health awareness and actual practices, and the lack of student-centred interventions. The significance of the study lies in its potential to benefit individual students, educational institutions, and society at large, while aligning with national health priorities and amplifying student voices in the process.

1.3 STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

Despite increasing awareness about health and wellness, many Generation Z students continue to follow lifestyle patterns that may harm their long-term well-being. Common issues include:

- Inadequate or irregular sleep due to late-night studying or screen time.
- Low levels of physical activity and exercise.
- Frequent consumption of junk food and irregular meal patterns.
- High daily screen time, especially on social media, which can affect concentration, sleep, and mood.
- Elevated stress levels related to academics, career uncertainty, and personal issues, with limited access to proper support or coping strategies.

This social project seeks to address these gaps by understanding students' current habits and perceptions through a structured questionnaire, and using those insights to suggest practical, youth-friendly strategies for healthier living.

1.4 OBJECTIVE OF THE STUDY:

- To understand the daily lifestyle habits of Generation Z students, including their sleep patterns, dietary habits, and levels of physical activity.
- To assess the extent of screen time and smartphone/social media usage among Gen Z students and its perceived impact on their sleep and daily routine.
- To study the mental and emotional well-being of students, including stress levels, coping mechanisms, and their comfort in discussing emotional issues with others.
- To evaluate how Gen Z students perceive their own lifestyle and to identify the key barriers (such as academic pressure, lack of time, motivation, cost, or social influence) that prevent them from adopting healthier habits.
- To gather suggestions and opinions from students on the changes needed, both at a personal and institutional level, to promote a healthier lifestyle among Generation Z.
- To create awareness among students about the importance of small, sustainable lifestyle changes for long-term physical and mental well-being.
- To use the findings to design and recommend practical, student-friendly interventions and awareness programmes that encourage sustainable healthy habits among Generation Z students.
- To promote open conversations about mental health and reduce stigma around seeking support for emotional well-being among students.

- To encourage peer support and community-driven initiatives that foster healthier lifestyle choices among Generation Z students.
- To contribute to the existing body of knowledge on Generation Z health and lifestyle in the Indian context, providing a basis for future research and interventions.

1.5 SCOPE OF THE STUDY:

The scope of this study defines its boundaries, focus areas, and the extent to which the findings can be applied. For the social project “Healthy Lifestyle for Generation Z Students,” the scope has been designed to ensure that the study remains focused, manageable, and relevant to the target population.

Target Population:

This study focuses on Generation Z students, typically in the age group of **15 to 26 years**, including higher secondary school students, undergraduate college students, and postgraduate students.

Geographic Scope:

The study is primarily confined to students in **Tiruchirappalli**. While the findings may offer insights relevant to other regions, the data collected reflects the specific cultural, educational, and socio-economic context of this location.

Thematic Scope:

The project examines healthy lifestyle through a holistic lens, covering the following dimensions:

- Physical lifestyle habits (sleep, physical activity, diet, water intake)
- Technology and digital habits (smartphone usage, social media, screen time before sleep)
- Mental and emotional well-being (stress, coping mechanisms, comfort in discussing emotional problems)
- Awareness and perceptions (self-assessment of healthy lifestyle, barriers, areas for improvement, suggestions)

Methodological Scope:

The study employs a **survey-based descriptive research design**, using a structured questionnaire as the primary data collection tool. The questionnaire consists of 22 questions divided into five sections. Data was collected through **Google Forms / offline distribution**.

Limitations of Scope:

The following limitations are acknowledged:

- The sample size may be limited, affecting generalisability.
- Data is self-reported and may be subject to bias.
- The study captures lifestyle habits at a single point in time (cross-sectional design).

Despite these limitations, the study provides meaningful insights that can guide future interventions and support healthier lifestyles among Generation Z students.

CHAPTER 2 – REVIEW OF LITERATURE

2.1 Introduction

The review of literature provides an understanding of existing research related to the healthy lifestyle of Generation Z students. It focuses on major areas such as **dietary habits, physical activity, sleep, screen time, stress and mental well-being**. Reviewing previous studies helps understand the health and lifestyle challenges faced by Generation Z and identify the research gap addressed by the present study.

2.2 Generation Z: Characteristics and Health Context

Generation Z refers to individuals born between the mid-1990s and early 2010s, who have grown up in a fully digital world (Deloitte, 2025). In India, this generation constitutes a large segment of the population, with distinct attitudes towards education, career, health, and lifestyle.

According to the **Burson Global Gen Z Report (2025)**, 78% of Indian Gen Z feel positive about taking responsibility for their own health, and 63% give high importance to mental health (Burson, 2025). The report also found that 67% of Indian Gen Z now prioritise their physical health more than before, reflecting a shift towards preventive care and holistic wellness (Health and Me, 2025).

However, despite this awareness, many struggle to maintain consistent healthy habits. The **ICICI Lombard India Wellness Index 2025** reported that Gen Z shows declines across all six wellness pillars — physical, mental, financial, workplace, social, and family — with the steepest drops in ability to cope with stress, maintaining a healthy diet, sleep quality, and access to mental health support (ICICI Lombard, 2025; Business Standard, 2025).

2.3 Lifestyle Patterns Among Students

Recent studies highlight concerning lifestyle trends among young students in India:

Sleep: The ICICI Lombard Wellness Index 2025 found that Gen Z reports significant decline in sleep quality, with many students sleeping less than the recommended 7–8 hours due to late-night studying and screen use (ICICI Lombard, 2025).

Physical Activity: A study on screen time and physical activity among students found that higher screen time was significantly associated with lower physical activity levels and poorer sleep quality (International Journal of Community Medicine and Public Health, 2024).

Diet: The ICICI Lombard report noted that while 66% of Indians admitted to following a balanced diet, they failed to reduce sugar, salt, or fat due to factors like lack of time, motivation, or awareness (Financial Express, 2025). Frequent consumption of junk food and irregular meal patterns are commonly reported among students.

Water Intake: Many young people do not drink enough water daily, affecting energy levels and concentration, though this area remains under-researched in the Indian context.

2.4 Technology Use and Screen Time

Technology plays a central role in Gen Z students' lives. According to the **Economic Survey 2024-25**, Indians spent an average of 4.95 hours per day on phone apps in 2024, with most of those hours belonging to teenagers (YourStory, 2025).

A study conducted at Isra University, Hyderabad (2024) with 152 participants found that average daily screen time was 5.85 hours, significantly higher among those with lower GPAs and low physical activity levels (The Journal of Health Sciences, 2025). The study also found that screen time positively correlated with depression ($r = 0.81$), anxiety ($r = 0.78$), stress ($r = 0.83$), and poor sleep quality ($r = 0.75$).

Another study found that specific types of screen time, such as small screen recreation on weekends and education and social activities on weekdays, were associated with poorer sleep quality among students in Mysuru city, Karnataka (International Journal of Community Medicine and Public Health, 2024).

2.5 Mental Health and Stress Among Gen Z in India

Recent reports indicate that Gen Z in India experiences high levels of stress and anxiety:

According to **Deloitte's Global Gen Z and Millennial Survey 2025**, 40% of Gen Z respondents say they feel stressed or anxious all or most of the time, with financial concerns and work-related pressures being the top stressors (Deloitte, 2025; India Today, 2025).

The **ICICI Lombard Wellness Index 2025** found that one in three Indians is suffering from high daily stress, with Gen Z showing the steepest decline in mental wellness compared to other generations (ICICI Lombard, 2025; GTNTV, 2025).

A study on mental health literacy among Generation Z students found that 49% of Gen Z in India report consistent anxiety and stress (All Study Journal, 2025). Common coping mechanisms include listening to music, talking to friends, or using social media; fewer report exercise or professional help.

Barriers to mental health support include stigma, lack of confidential services, cost, and limited awareness (RSIS International, 2026).

2.6 Existing Interventions and Programmes

Various initiatives have been undertaken to promote healthy lifestyles among youth in India:

- School and college-based wellness workshops on stress management, nutrition, and physical activity
- Digital mental health campaigns by organisations like YourStory and Health and Me
- NGO-led programmes on digital well-being and screen time management
- Government initiatives such as Fit India Movement and National Mental Health Programme

However, many efforts are fragmented or short-term, with limited student participation in design (ICICI Lombard, 2025).

2.7 Summary and Research Gap

The literature indicates that Generation Z students in India face significant challenges in maintaining a healthy lifestyle, with a gap between awareness and action (Burson, 2025; ICICI Lombard, 2025; Deloitte, 2025). Key gaps include:

- Limited integration of mental health and digital well-being into lifestyle efforts
- Insufficient student participation in intervention design
- Lack of context-specific, practical guidance for Indian students

This project addresses these gaps by collecting primary data directly from students through a structured questionnaire, focusing on multiple health dimensions, and incorporating student suggestions into recommendations.

CHAPTER 3 – RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Type of Study

This project employs a **descriptive survey-based research design**. The primary aim is to describe the current lifestyle patterns, perceptions, and challenges faced by Generation Z students with regard to physical health, mental well-being, technology use, and healthy lifestyle awareness. The study is **cross-sectional**, meaning that data was collected at a single point in time rather than over an extended period.

3.2 Population and Sample

Target Population:

The target population for this study consists of Generation Z students, defined as individuals born between the mid-1990s and early 2010s. In practical terms, this includes students in the age group of approximately 15 to 26 years, encompassing higher secondary school students, undergraduate college students, and postgraduate students.

Sample Size:

The study included a total of 171 respondents who completed the questionnaire.

Sampling Method:

A **convenience sampling** method was used to select respondents. This means that the questionnaire was distributed to students who were easily accessible and willing to participate.

3.3 Data Collection Tool

The primary data collection tool for this study is a **structured questionnaire** titled "Healthy Lifestyle for Generation Z Students." The questionnaire was designed to capture a comprehensive picture of students' lifestyle habits across multiple dimensions. It consists of **22 questions** divided into five sections:

1. **General Information** (age, gender, level of study)
2. **Daily Lifestyle** (sleep duration, physical activity, fruit and vegetable consumption, junk food consumption, water intake)
3. **Technology and Screen Time** (smartphone usage, social media usage, device use before sleep, perceived impact of screen time)
4. **Mental and Emotional Well-being** (stress frequency, coping mechanisms, time for hobbies, comfort in discussing emotional problems)
5. **Awareness and Healthy Choices** (self-perception of healthy lifestyle, barriers, areas for improvement, opinion on institutional programmes, open-ended suggestions)

The questionnaire includes a mix of **multiple-choice questions**, **rating-scale questions**, and **two open-ended questions** (Q21 and Q22). This combination allows for both quantitative analysis (through percentages and frequencies) and qualitative insights (through students' own words and suggestions).

3.4 Data Collection Procedure

The data collection process was carried out in the following steps:

1. **Questionnaire Design:** The questionnaire was designed based on a review of existing literature on Generation Z health, lifestyle, and mental well-being. The questions were structured to align with the objectives of the study and to cover all relevant dimensions of healthy lifestyle.
2. **Distribution:** The final questionnaire was created in **Google Forms**. The form link was shared with respondents through **WhatsApp**, and a **QR code** was also generated and shown to respondents to scan and fill the questionnaire directly on their smartphones. This dual approach ensured that respondents could access the questionnaire easily, whether through a direct link or by scanning the QR code.
3. **Ethical Considerations:** Participation in the survey was entirely **voluntary**, and respondents were informed that they could withdraw at any time without consequences. No personally identifiable information (such as names, email addresses, or phone numbers) was collected, ensuring the anonymity and privacy of participants. Respondents were also informed about the purpose of the study and how the data would be used.

3.5 Data Analysis

Once the data collection was completed, the responses were exported from Google Forms to **Microsoft Excel**, and then imported into **SPSS (Statistical Package for the Social Sciences)** for analysis. The analysis process involved the following steps:

1. **Data Cleaning:** Responses were reviewed to ensure completeness and consistency. Incomplete or duplicate responses were excluded from the analysis.
2. **Quantitative Analysis:** For multiple-choice and rating-scale questions, **frequencies and percentages** were calculated using SPSS. These percentages were used to create **tables and bar charts** for each question to visually represent the distribution of responses.
3. **Qualitative Analysis:** For the two open-ended questions (Q21: most important healthy habit, and Q22: suggestions for healthier living), responses were read carefully and grouped into common themes. For instance, many students may mention "sleep," "exercise," "balanced diet," or "stress

management" as important habits. These themes were identified and summarised to capture the key ideas expressed by respondents.

4. **Interpretation:** The quantitative and qualitative findings were interpreted in the context of the study's objectives and existing research on Generation Z health and lifestyle. Patterns were identified, and connections were drawn between different variables (e.g., the relationship between screen time and sleep quality, or between academic pressure and stress levels).

3.6 Limitations of the Methodology

While the methodology was designed to be appropriate for the scope of the project, certain limitations are acknowledged:

- **Sample Size:** The number of respondents may be limited, which affects the generalisability of the findings to larger populations.
- **Sampling Bias:** The use of convenience sampling means that the sample may not fully represent the diversity of Gen Z students across different regions, institutions, or socio-economic backgrounds.
- **Self-Reported Data:** The questionnaire relies on students' own perceptions and self-reported behaviours, which may be subject to recall bias or social desirability bias.
- **Cross-Sectional Design:** The study captures lifestyle habits at a single point in time, rather than tracking changes over an extended period.
- **No Pilot Testing:** The questionnaire was not pilot-tested before full-scale distribution, which means some questions may have had unclear wording or response options.

These limitations do not invalidate the findings but rather provide context for interpreting the results and identifying areas for improvement in future studies.

3.7 Summary

In summary, this study employed a descriptive survey-based approach to understand the lifestyle habits and perceptions of Generation Z students. A structured questionnaire with 22 questions across five sections was created in Google Forms and distributed to students through **WhatsApp link and QR code**. Data was collected and analysed using quantitative and qualitative methods in Google Sheets to identify key patterns and insights. While certain methodological limitations are acknowledged, the approach taken is appropriate for the scope and objectives of this social project.

CHAPTER 4 - DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

4.1 Demographic Profile

4.1.1 Age

Particular	Frequenc y	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulativ e Percent
17	14	8.2	8.2	8.2
18	23	13.5	13.5	21.6
19	36	21.1	21.1	42.7
20	33	19.3	19.3	62.0
21	31	18.1	18.1	80.1
22	23	13.5	13.5	93.6
23	8	4.7	4.7	98.2
24	2	1.2	1.2	99.4
25	1	.6	.6	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.1.1 Age

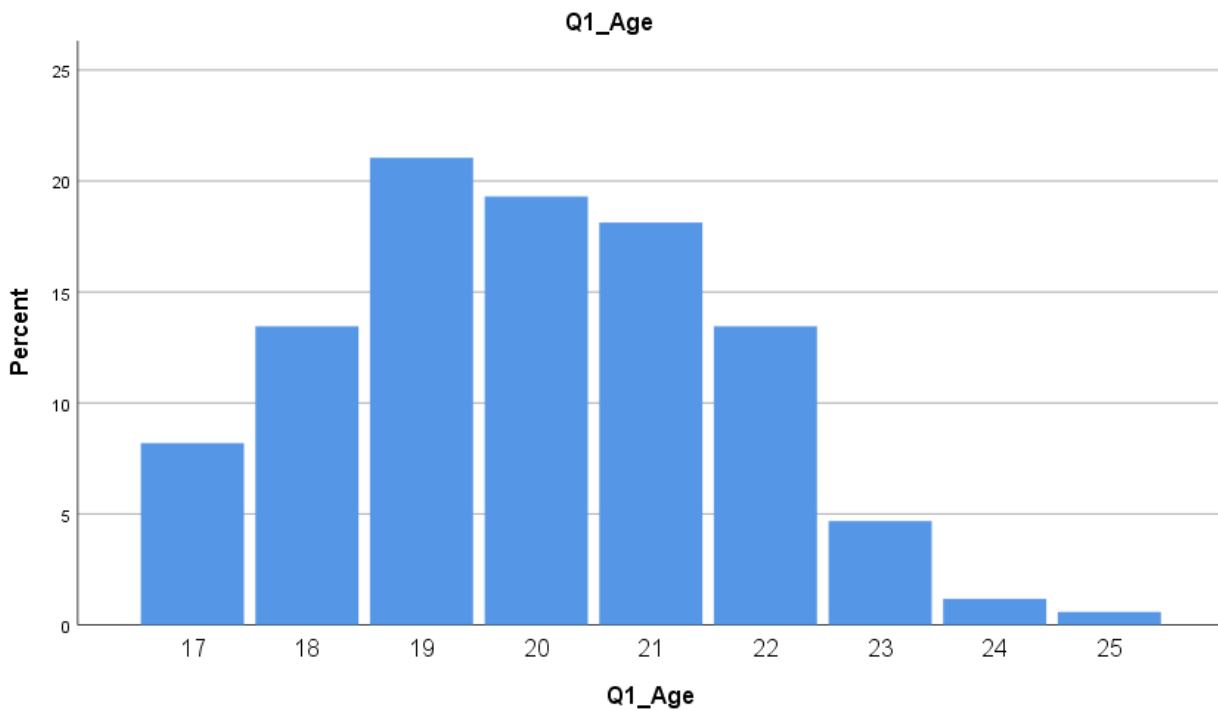


Figure 4.1.1 Age

Inference:

Among the 171 respondents, the highest proportion of respondents are **19 years old (21.1%)**, followed by **20 years old (19.3%)** and **21 years old (18.1%)**. Respondents aged **17 to 22 years account for 93.6%** of

the total sample, indicating that the study predominantly consists of young Generation Z students. The lowest proportion of respondents are **25 years old (0.6%)**.

4.1.2 Gender

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Male	102	59.6	59.6	59.6
Female	69	40.4	40.4	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.1.2 Gender

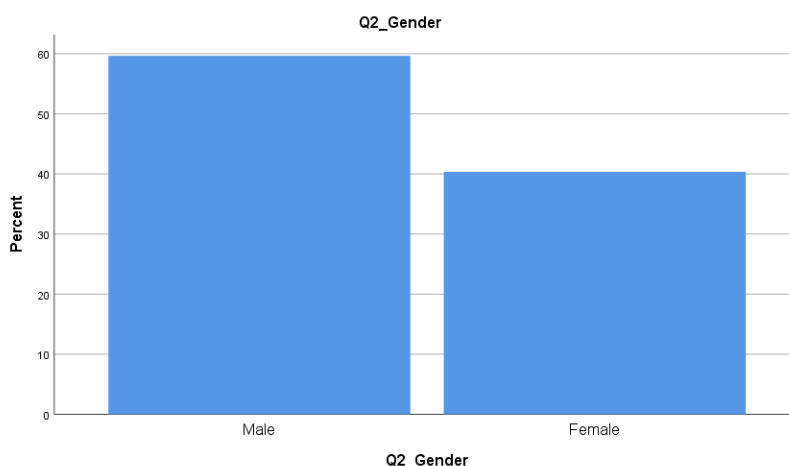


Figure 4.1.2 Gender

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, 102 respondents (59.6%) are male, while 69 respondents (40.4%) are female. Therefore, the study consists of a higher proportion of male respondents than female respondents.

4.1.3 Level of Study

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Undergraduate	118	69.0	69.0	69.0
Postgraduate	50	29.2	29.2	98.2
Dip Horticulture	1	.6	.6	98.8
School	2	1.2	1.2	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.1.3 Level of Study

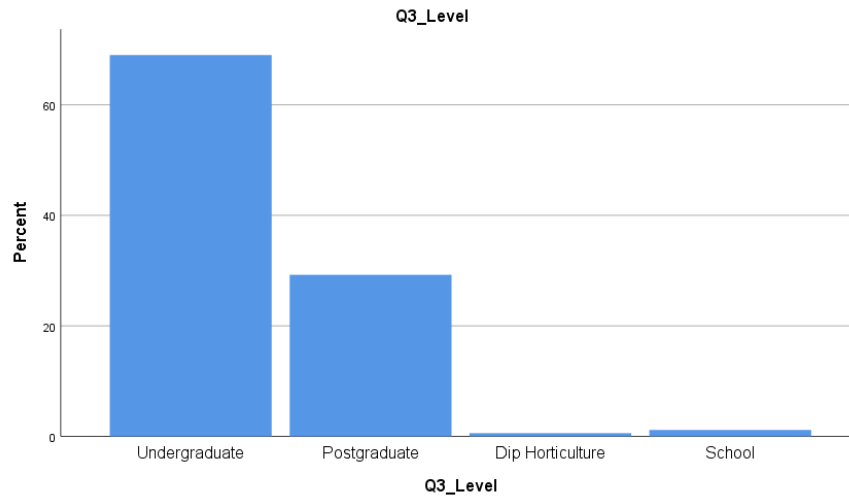


Figure 4.1.3 Level of Study

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, the majority are undergraduate students (69.0%), followed by postgraduate students (29.2%). Only 1.2% of the respondents are school students and 0.6% are diploma students. Therefore, the study is predominantly represented by undergraduate students.

4.2 Daily Lifestyle Practices

4.2.1 Sleep

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Less than 5 hours	17	9.9	9.9	9.9
5-6 hours	59	34.5	34.5	44.4
7-8 hours	73	42.7	42.7	87.1
More than 8 hours	22	12.9	12.9	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.2.1 Sleep

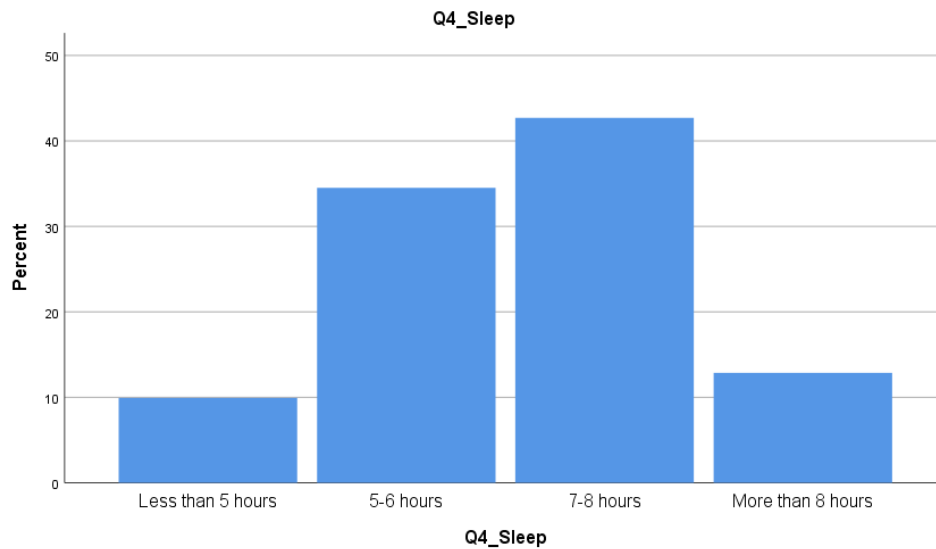


Figure 4.2.1 Sleep

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, the majority (42.7%) reported getting 7–8 hours of sleep, followed by 34.5% who reported 5–6 hours. About 12.9% sleep more than 8 hours, while 9.9% sleep less than 5 hours. This indicates that most respondents reported getting 5–8 hours of sleep per day.

4.2.2 Exercise

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Never	44	25.7	25.7	25.7
1-2 days a week	74	43.3	43.3	69.0
3-4 days a week	27	15.8	15.8	84.8
5 or more days a week	26	15.2	15.2	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.2.2 Exercise

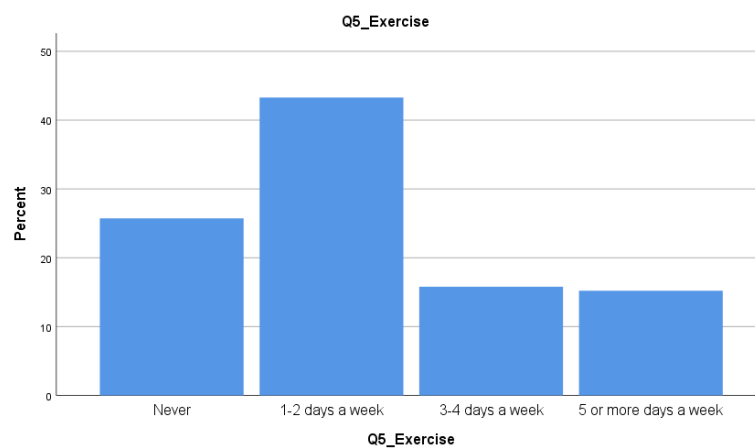


Figure 4.2.2 Exercise

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, the majority (**43.3%**) reported exercising **1–2 days a week**. About 25.7% reported that they never exercise, while 15.8% exercise 3–4 days a week and 15.2% exercise 5 or more days a week. This indicates that most respondents exercise only **1–2 days per week**.

4.2.3 Fruit and Vegetable Consumption

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Rarely	22	12.9	12.9	12.9
Sometimes	72	42.1	42.1	55.0
Often	27	15.8	15.8	70.8
Every day	50	29.2	29.2	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.2.3 Fruit and vegetable Consumption

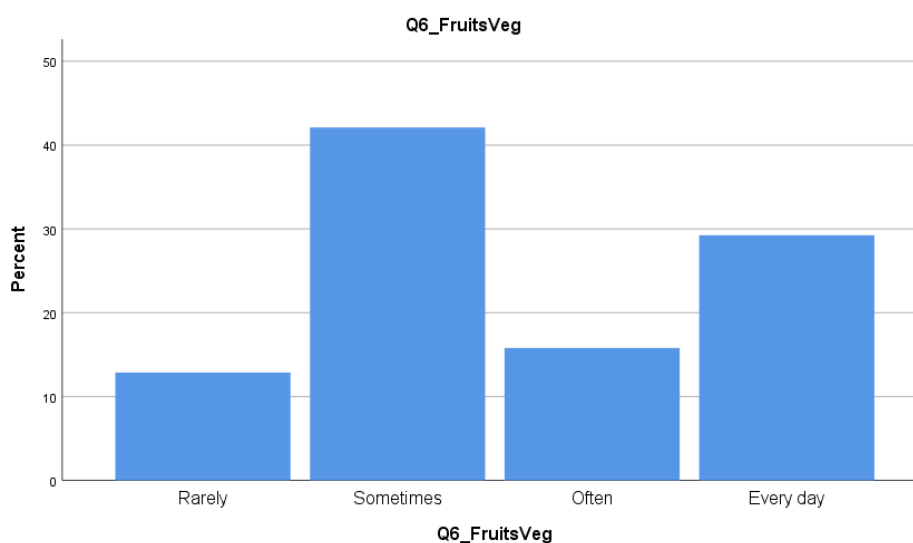


Figure 4.2.3 Fruit and Vegetable Consumption

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, the majority (**42.1%**) reported consuming fruits and vegetables **sometimes**, while 29.2% consume them every day. About 15.8% consume them often and 12.9% rarely. This indicates that although a considerable proportion consumes fruits and vegetables daily, the largest group consumes them only sometimes.

4.2.4 Fast Food / Junk Food Consumption

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Never	15	8.8	8.8	8.8
Rarely	46	26.9	26.9	35.7
Sometimes	83	48.5	48.5	84.2
Often	16	9.4	9.4	93.6
Daily	11	6.4	6.4	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.2.4 Frequency of Fast Food / Junk Food Consumption

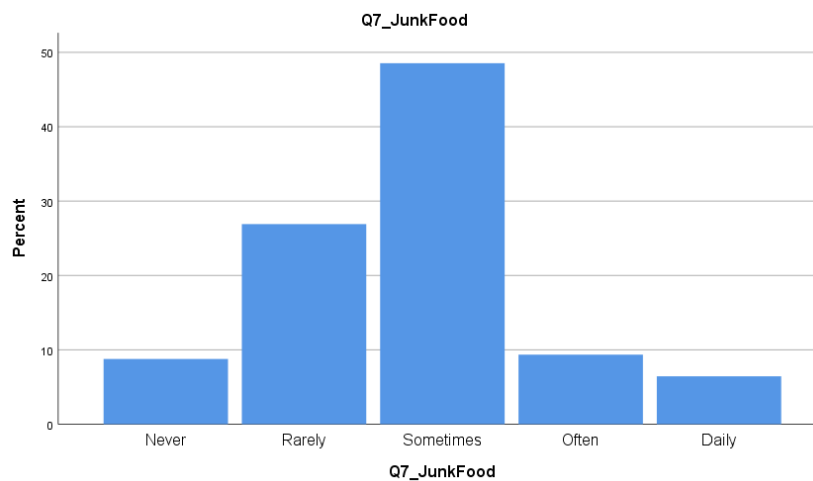


Figure 4.2.4 Fast Food / Junk Food Consumption

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, 48.5% reported that they consume fast food or junk food sometimes, which is the highest proportion. This is followed by 26.9% who consume it rarely. About 9.4% consume fast food or junk food often, while 8.8% never consume it and 6.4% consume it daily. Therefore, the majority of respondents consume fast food or junk food sometimes.

4.2.5 Water Consumption

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Less than 1 litre	17	9.9	9.9	9.9
1-2 litres	49	28.7	28.7	38.6
2-3 litres	69	40.4	40.4	78.9
More than 3 litres	36	21.1	21.1	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.2.5 Water Consumption

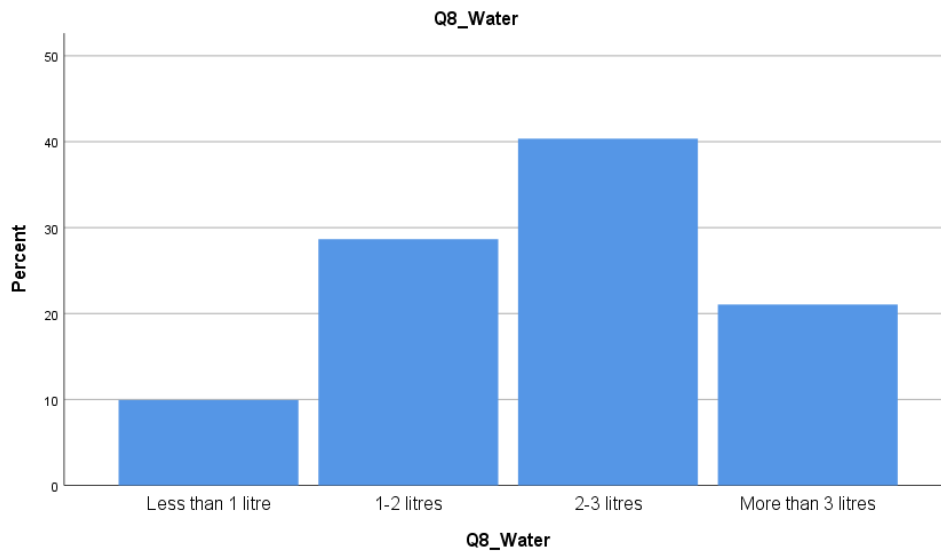


Figure 4.2.5 Water Consumption

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, the majority (40.4%) reported consuming 2–3 litres of water per day. This is followed by 28.7% consuming 1–2 litres and 21.1% consuming more than 3 litres. Only 9.9% consume less than 1 litre. Therefore, most respondents reported consuming 2–3 litres of water per day.

4.3 Technology and Screen Time

4.3.1 Smartphone Usage

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Less than 2 hours	23	13.5	13.5	13.5
2-4 hours	54	31.6	31.6	45.0
4-6 hours	59	34.5	34.5	79.5
More than 6 hours	35	20.5	20.5	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.3.1 Smartphone Usage

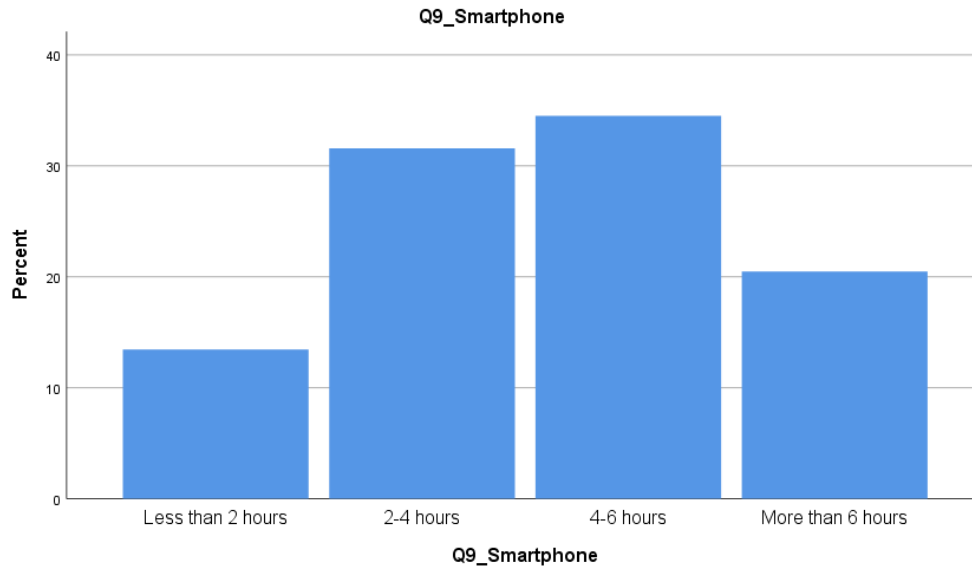


Figure 4.3.1 Smartphone Usage

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, the highest proportion (34.5%) reported using smartphones for 4–6 hours per day, followed by 31.6% who use them for 2–4 hours. About 20.5% reported using smartphones for more than 6 hours, while 13.5% use them for less than 2 hours. Therefore, smartphone usage is relatively high among the respondents, with the largest group spending 4–6 hours per day on smartphones.

4.3.2 Social Media Usage

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Less than 1 hours	25	14.6	14.6	14.6
1-2 hours	55	32.2	32.2	46.8
2-4 hours	60	35.1	35.1	81.9
More than 4 hours	31	18.1	18.1	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.3.2 Social Media Usage

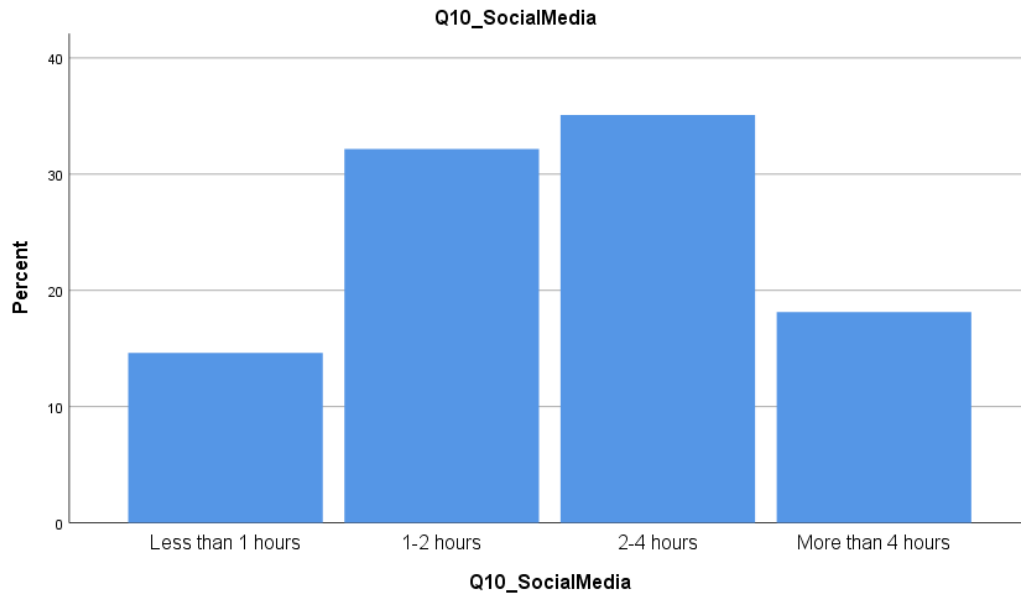


Figure 4.3.2 Social Media Usage

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, 35.1% reported using social media for 2–4 hours per day, which is the highest proportion. This is followed by 32.2% who use social media for 1–2 hours. About 18.1% spend more than 4 hours, while 14.6% spend less than 1 hour per day. Therefore, the majority of respondents spend 1–4 hours per day on social media.

4.3.3 Device Usage Before Sleep

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Never	8	4.7	4.7	4.7
Sometimes	59	34.5	34.5	39.2
Often	32	18.7	18.7	57.9
Always	72	42.1	42.1	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.3.3 Device Usage Before Sleep

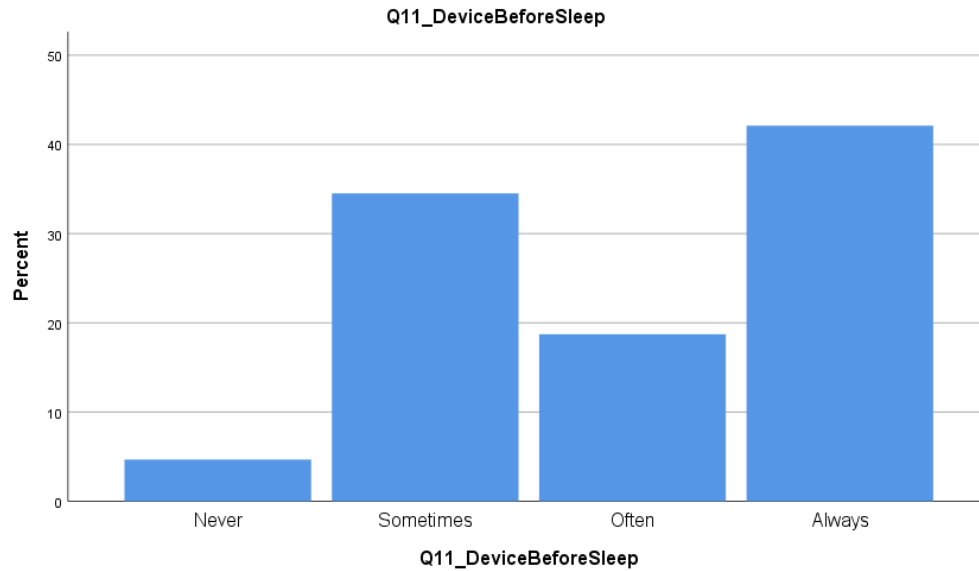


Figure 4.3.3 Device Usage Before Sleep

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, 42.1% reported that they always use a device before sleep, representing the highest proportion. This is followed by 34.5% who do so sometimes and 18.7% who do so often. Only 4.7% reported never using a device before sleep. Therefore, device usage before sleep is common among the respondents.

4.3.4 Effect of Excessive Screen Time

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
No	55	32.2	32.2	32.2
Not sure	35	20.5	20.5	52.6
Yes	81	47.4	47.4	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.3.4 Effect of Excessive Screen Time

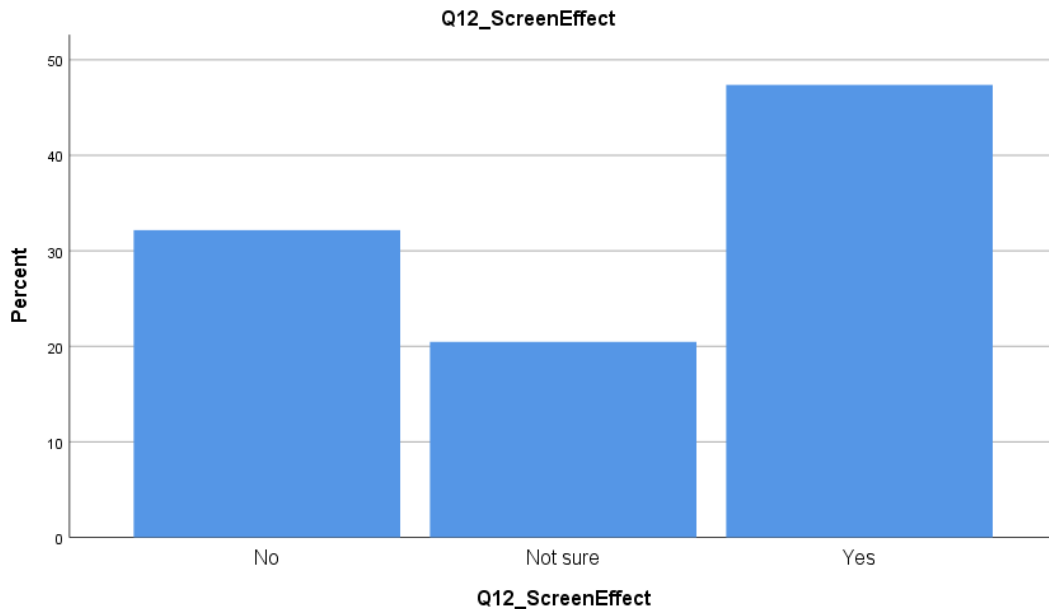


Figure 4.3.4 Effect of Excessive Screen Time

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, **47.4%** stated that excessive screen time affects their sleep or physical activity, while **32.2%** stated that it does not. **20.5%** of the respondents were not sure. Therefore, the findings indicate that **nearly half of the respondents perceive excessive screen time as having an effect on their sleep or physical activity.**

4.4 Mental and Emotional Well-being

4.4.1 Stress

Particulars	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Never	19	11.1	11.1	11.1
Rarely	45	26.3	26.3	37.4
Sometimes	66	38.6	38.6	76.0
Often	18	10.5	10.5	86.5
Always	23	13.5	13.5	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.4.1 Stress

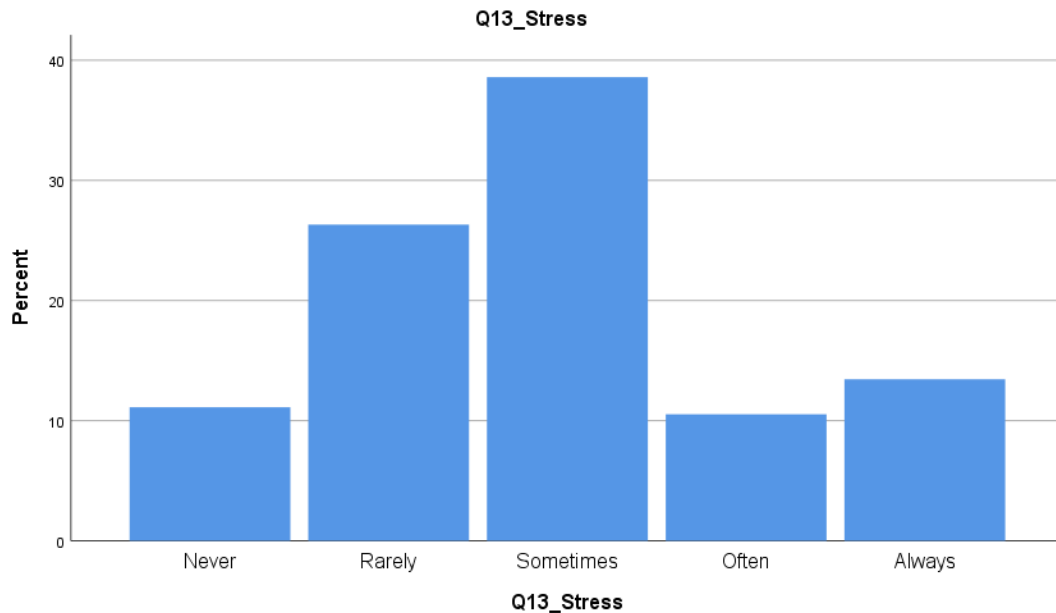


Figure 4.4.1 Stress

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, **11.1%** reported that they never feel stressed due to studies, work, or personal issues, while **26.3%** reported feeling stressed rarely. **38.6%** reported feeling stressed sometimes, **10.5%** reported feeling stressed often, and **13.5%** reported feeling stressed always. The highest proportion of respondents (**38.6%**) experience stress **sometimes**, indicating that occasional stress is common among the respondents.

4.4.2 Stress Management

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Talking to friends or family	59	34.5	34.5	34.5
Listening to music	47	27.5	27.5	62.0
Exercise/sports	27	15.8	15.8	77.8
Sleeping	16	9.4	9.4	87.1
Watching videos/using social media	15	8.8	8.8	95.9
meditation videos/using social media	4	2.3	2.3	98.2
Playing	1	.6	.6	98.8
Games	1	.6	.6	99.4
Silent	1	.6	.6	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.4.2 Stress Management

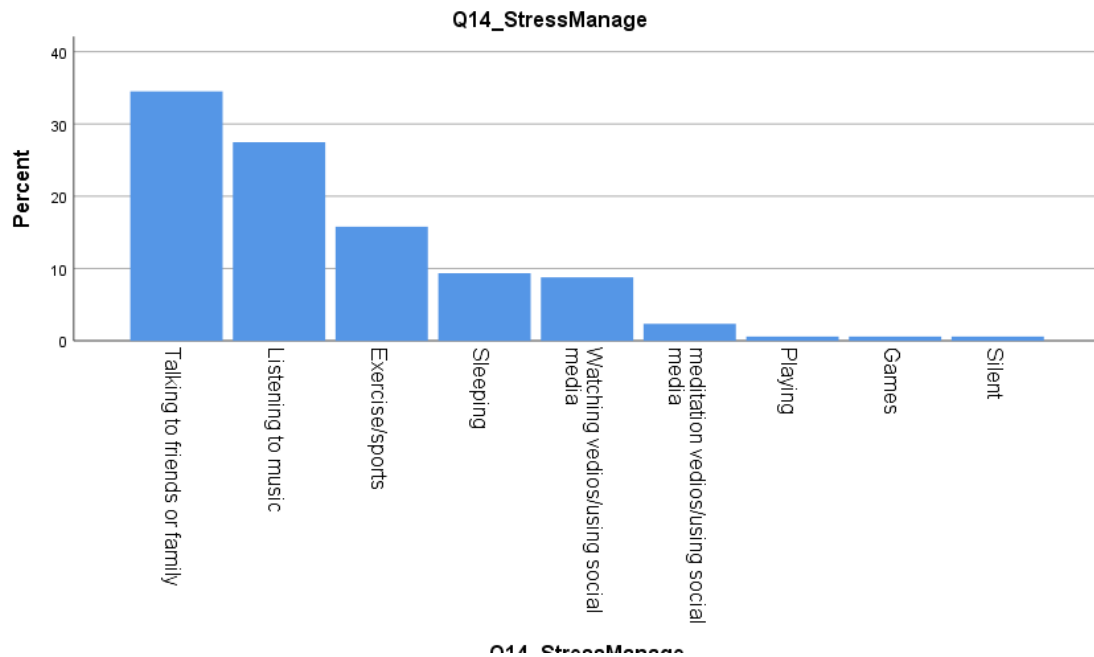


Figure 4.4.2 Stress Management

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, 34.5% manage stress by talking to friends or family, 27.5% by listening to music, 15.8% through exercise/sports, 9.4% through sleeping, 8.8% by watching videos/using social media, 2.3% through meditation, and 0.6% each through playing, games, and staying silent. Thus, talking to friends or family (34.5%) is the most common way of managing stress, followed by listening to music (27.5%).

4.4.3 Hobbies

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Never	3	1.8	1.8	1.8
Rarely	24	14.0	14.0	15.8
Occasionally	34	19.9	19.9	35.7
Several times a week	55	32.2	32.2	67.8
Daily	55	32.2	32.2	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.4.3 Hobbies

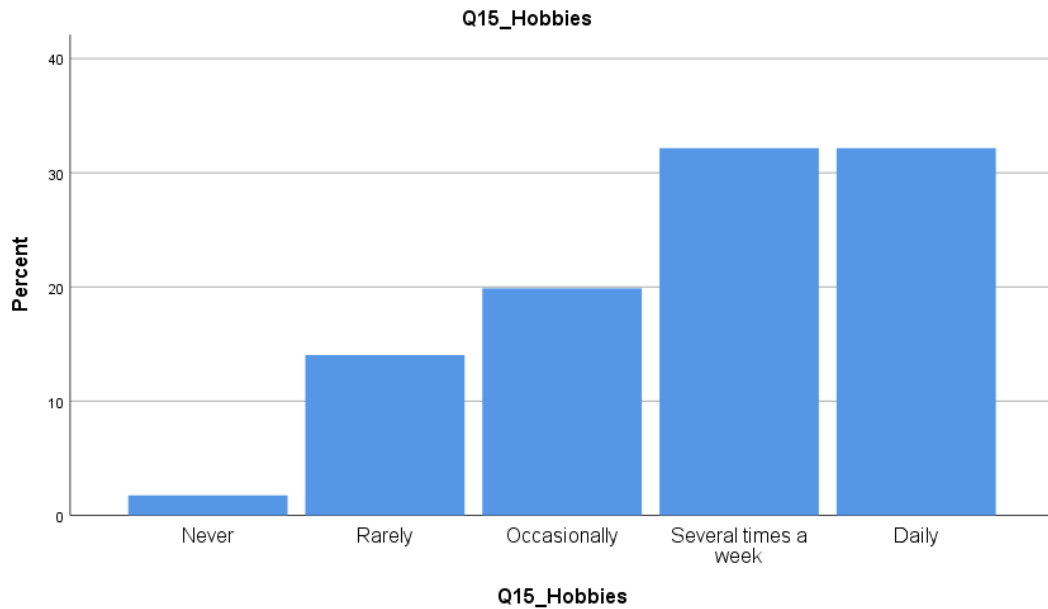


Figure 4.4.3 Hobbies

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, 1.8% reported that they never take time for hobbies or activities they enjoy, while 14.0% do so rarely. 19.9% take time occasionally, 32.2% do so several times a week, and 32.2% engage in hobbies or enjoyable activities daily. Thus, the highest proportions are several times a week (32.2%) and daily (32.2%), indicating that most respondents regularly make time for hobbies or activities they enjoy.

4.4.4 Emotional Support

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
No	33	19.3	19.3	19.3
Sometimes	25	14.6	14.6	33.9
Yes	113	66.1	66.1	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.4.4 Emotional Support

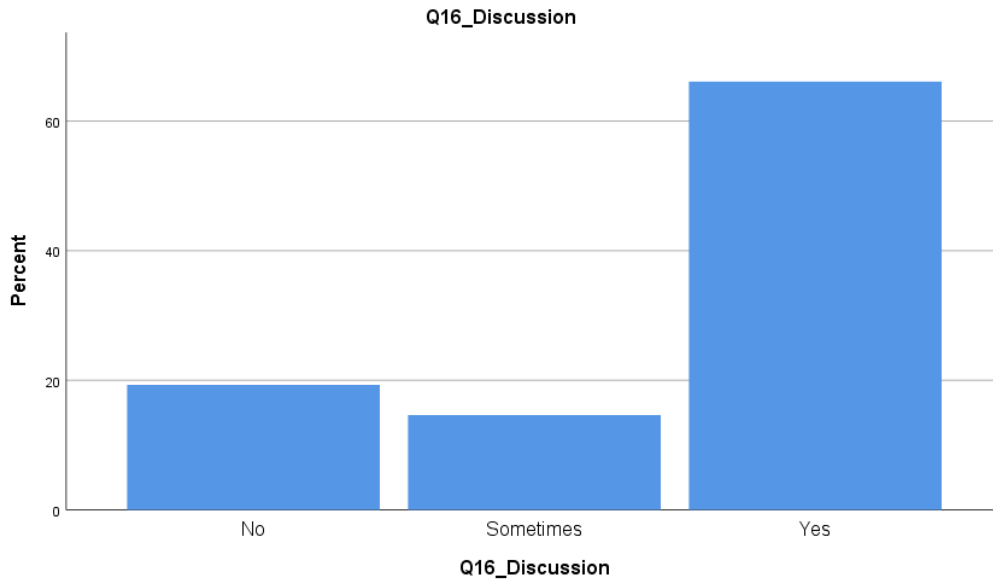


Figure 4.4.4 Emotional Support

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, **19.3%** reported that they are not comfortable discussing their mental or emotional problems with someone they trust, while **14.6%** feel comfortable **sometimes**. A majority of **66.1%** reported that they **are comfortable** discussing such problems with someone they trust. Thus, the findings indicate that **most respondents are comfortable discussing their mental or emotional problems with a trusted person.**

4.5.1 Healthy Lifestyle Perception

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
No	49	28.7	28.7	28.7
Not sure	31	18.1	18.1	46.8
Yes	91	53.2	53.2	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.5.1 Healthy Lifestyle Perception

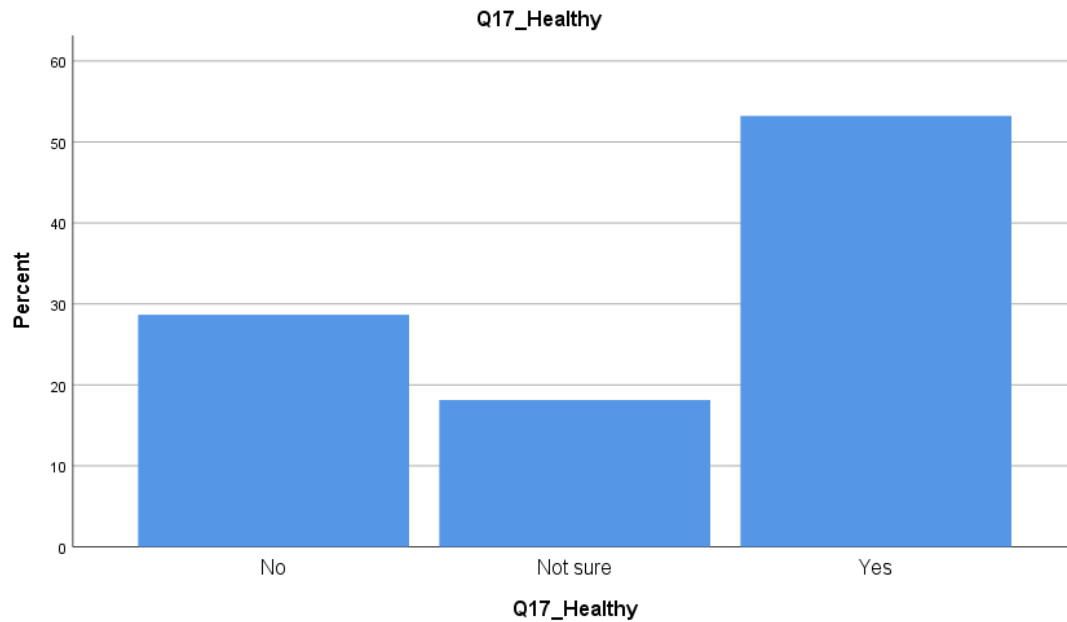


Figure 4.5.1 Healthy Lifestyle perception

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, **28.7%** reported **No**, indicating that they do not consider themselves to maintain a healthy lifestyle, while **18.1%** were **not sure**. A majority of **53.2%** responded **Yes**, indicating that they consider themselves to maintain a healthy lifestyle. Thus, **yes (53.2%)** was the highest response among the respondents.

4.5.2 Barriers

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Lack of time	42	24.6	24.6	24.6
Lack of motivation	32	18.7	18.7	43.3
Academic pressure	32	18.7	18.7	62.0
Excessive screen time	30	17.5	17.5	79.5
Cost of healthy food	23	13.5	13.5	93.0
Social influence	8	4.7	4.7	97.7
Work pressure	1	.6	.6	98.2
Emotional pressure	1	.6	.6	98.8
People's	1	.6	.6	99.4
Nothing	1	.6	.6	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.5.2 Barriers

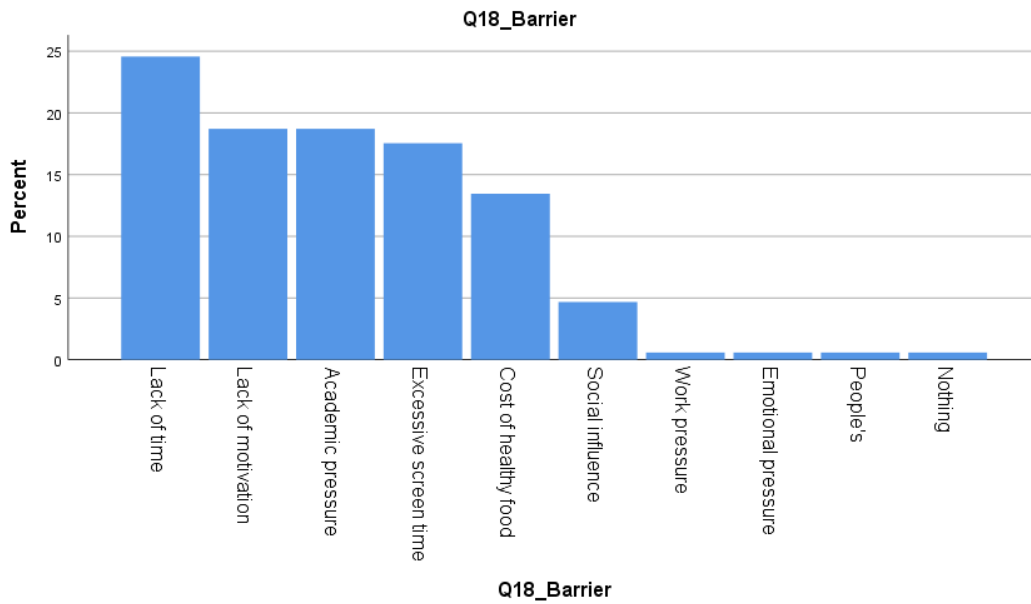


Figure 4.5.2 Barrier

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, 24.6% identified lack of time as a barrier to maintaining a healthy lifestyle, followed by 18.7% who reported lack of motivation and 18.7% who reported academic pressure. 17.5% identified excessive screen time, while 13.5% reported the cost of healthy food as a barrier. 4.7% identified social influence, while work pressure, emotional pressure, people's* and nothing were each reported by 0.6%. Thus, lack of time (24.6%) is the most commonly reported barrier, followed by lack of motivation and academic pressure (18.7% each).

4.5.3 Areas for Improvement

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Sleep	46	26.9	26.9	26.9
Exercise	44	25.7	25.7	52.6
Time management	24	14.0	14.0	66.7
Diet	21	12.3	12.3	78.9
Stress management	20	11.7	11.7	90.6
Screen time	16	9.4	9.4	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.5.3 Areas for Improvement

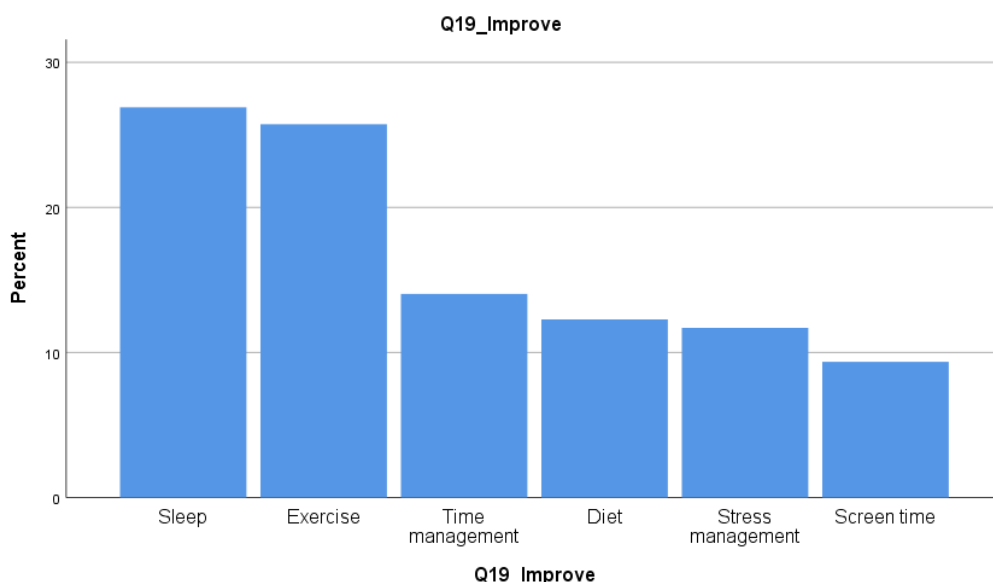


Figure 4.5.3 Areas for Improvement

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, 26.9% identified sleep as the area they would most like to improve, followed by 25.7% who selected exercise. 14.0% wanted to improve time management, while 12.3% selected diet. 11.7% wanted to improve stress management and 9.4% selected screen time. Thus, sleep (26.9%) is the most commonly identified area for improvement, followed closely by exercise (25.7%).

4.5.4 Healthy Lifestyle Programmes

Particular	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
No	38	22.2	22.2	22.2
Not sure	26	15.2	15.2	37.4
Yes	107	62.6	62.6	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.5.4 Healthy Lifestyle Programmes

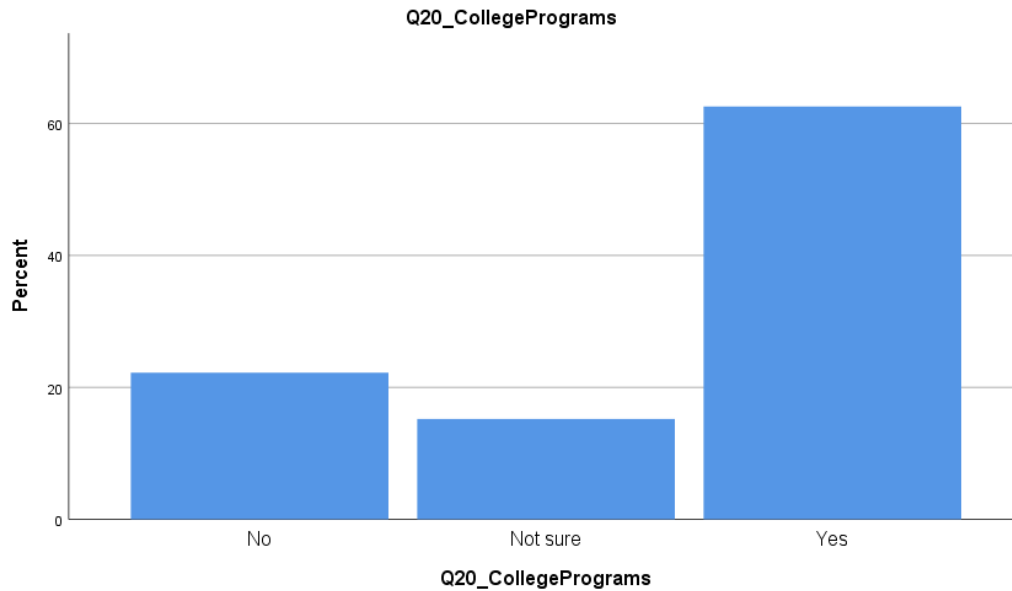


Figure 4.5.4 Healthy Lifestyle Programmes

Inference

Among the 171 respondents, **22.2%** stated **No**, indicating that they do not think schools and colleges should conduct healthy lifestyle programmes for Generation Z students. **15.2%** were **not sure**, while a majority of **62.6%** responded **Yes**. Thus, the findings indicate that **most respondents (62.6%) support conducting healthy lifestyle programmes in schools and colleges for Generation Z students**.

4.5.5 Most Important Habit

Particulars	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Exercise / Physical Activity	14	8.2	8.2	8.2
Sleep	17	9.9	9.9	18.1
Healthy Diet	28	16.4	16.4	34.5
Stress Management	6	3.5	3.5	38.0
Lifestyle / Discipline	14	8.2	8.2	46.2
Screen-Time Reduction	2	1.2	1.2	47.4
Multiple Healthy Habits	27	15.8	15.8	63.2
No response	44	25.7	25.7	88.9
Unclear / Irrelevant	19	11.1	11.1	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.5.5 Most Important Habit

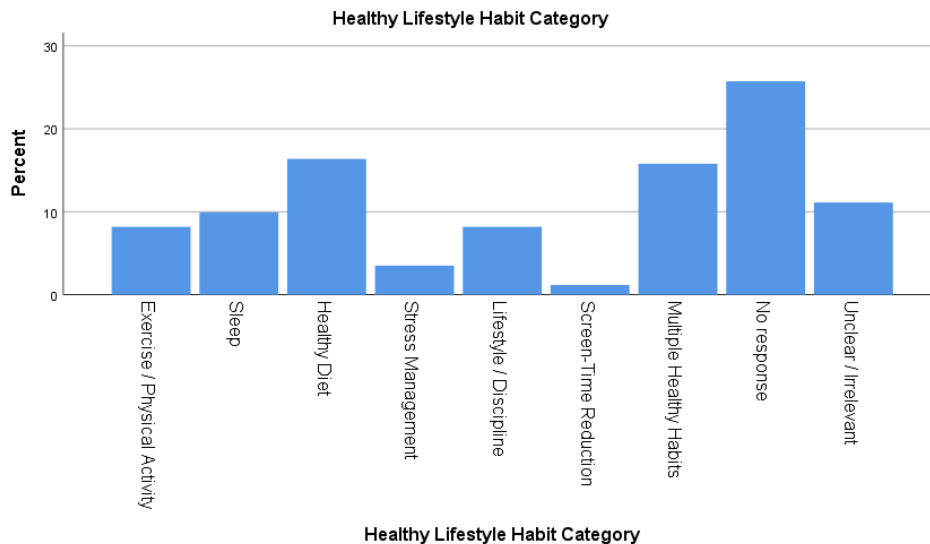


Figure 4.5.5 Most Important Habit

Inference

The table shows that **Healthy Diet** was the most commonly identified healthy lifestyle habit among the respondents, accounting for **16.4%**. This was followed closely by **Multiple Healthy Habits**, reported by **15.8%** of respondents, indicating that many Generation Z students considered a combination of healthy practices important. **Sleep** accounted for **9.9%**, while **Exercise / Physical Activity** and **Lifestyle / Discipline** each represented **8.2%**. **Stress Management** was reported by **3.5%**, whereas **Screen-Time Reduction** accounted for **1.2%**. A considerable **25.7%** of respondents provided **no response**, while **11.1%** gave **unclear or irrelevant responses**. Overall, the findings suggest that healthy eating and adopting multiple healthy habits were the most prominent healthy lifestyle practices identified by the respondents, while relatively fewer respondents focused specifically on stress management and screen-time reduction.

4.5.6 Healthy Lifestyle Suggestions

Particulars	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Healthy Diet / Food	17	9.9	9.9	9.9
Exercise / Physical Activity	7	4.1	4.1	14.0
Sleep	3	1.8	1.8	15.8
Screen-Time / Mobile Reduction	17	9.9	9.9	25.7
Stress Management / Mental Well-being	3	1.8	1.8	27.5
Discipline / Time Management	9	5.3	5.3	32.7
Multiple Healthy Lifestyle Suggestions	24	14.0	14.0	46.8
Positive Attitude / Self-Motivation	16	9.4	9.4	56.1
No Response / No Idea / Nothing	61	35.7	35.7	91.8
Unclear / Irrelevant	14	8.2	8.2	100.0
Total	171	100.0	100.0	

Table 4.5.6 Healthy Lifestyle Suggestions

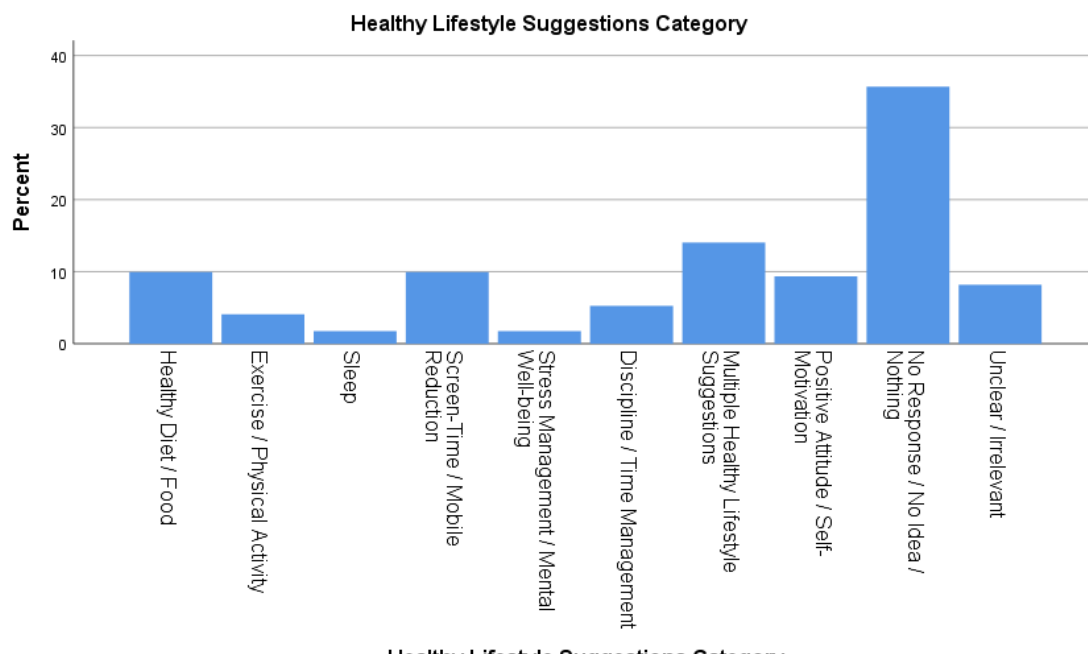


Figure 4.5.6 Healthy Lifestyle Suggestions

Inference

The table indicates that No Response / No Idea / Nothing was the largest category, accounting for 35.7% of the respondents. Among the specific suggestions, Multiple Healthy Lifestyle Suggestions was the most common category at 14.0%, showing that some respondents suggested a combination of healthy practices. Healthy Diet / Food and Screen-Time / Mobile Reduction were each reported by 9.9% of respondents, followed by Positive Attitude / Self-Motivation at 9.4%. Unclear / Irrelevant responses accounted for 8.2%, while Discipline / Time Management represented 5.3%. Exercise / Physical Activity accounted for 4.1%, whereas Sleep and Stress Management / Mental Well-being each represented 1.8%. Overall, the findings show that respondents who provided meaningful suggestions mainly emphasized a combination of healthy lifestyle practices, healthy food, and reducing excessive screen or mobile-phone use. However, the relatively high proportion of 35.7% with no specific response indicates that many respondents did not provide a clear suggestion.

CHAPTER 5 - FINDINGS, SUGGESTIONS AND CONCLUSION

5.1 FINDINGS

Based on the analysis of 171 respondents, the following major findings were identified:

1. **Age of the respondents:** The study found that the largest proportion of respondents were **19 years old (21.1%)**, followed by 20 years (19.3%) and 21 years (18.1%). Overall, the respondents were predominantly young Generation Z students.
2. **Gender distribution:** The study consisted of **59.6% male and 40.4% female respondents**, indicating a higher representation of male respondents.
3. **Level of study:** A majority of the respondents were **undergraduate students (69.0%)**, followed by postgraduate students (29.2%). Only a small proportion were school or diploma students.
4. **Sleep duration:** The largest proportion of respondents, **42.7%**, reported sleeping for **7–8 hours per night**, while 34.5% reported 5–6 hours. This indicates that although many respondents receive a reasonable amount of sleep, a considerable proportion have shorter sleep durations.
5. **Physical activity:** **43.3%** of respondents exercised only **1–2 days per week**, while 25.7% reported never exercising. This indicates that regular physical activity is relatively low among a considerable proportion of the respondents.
6. **Fruit and vegetable consumption:** The largest group, **42.1%**, consumed fruits and vegetables only sometimes, while 29.2% consumed them every day. This suggests that daily consumption of fruits and vegetables could be improved among the respondents.
7. **Fast food and junk food consumption:** **48.5%** of respondents consumed fast food or junk food sometimes, while 26.9% consumed it rarely. Although only 6.4% consumed it daily, occasional consumption was common among the respondents.
8. **Water consumption:** The largest proportion, **40.4%**, reported drinking **2–3 litres of water per day**, followed by 28.7% consuming 1–2 litres. This indicates generally adequate water consumption among many respondents.

9. **Smartphone usage:** The highest proportion, **34.5%**, used smartphones for **4–6 hours per day**, followed by 31.6% who used them for 2–4 hours. This shows relatively high smartphone usage among the respondents.
10. **Social media usage:** **35.1%** of respondents spent 2–4 hours per day on social media, while 32.2% spent 1–2 hours. Therefore, social media forms a significant part of the respondents' daily screen-time usage.
11. **Device usage before sleep:** A large proportion of respondents used phones or other devices before sleeping, with **42.1% always** doing so and 34.5% doing so sometimes. This indicates that device usage before sleep is common among the respondents.
12. **Effect of excessive screen time:** **47.4%** believed that excessive screen time affects their sleep or physical activity, while 20.5% were unsure. This highlights a perceived connection between excessive screen exposure and healthy daily routines.
13. **Stress levels:** The largest proportion, **38.6%**, reported feeling stressed sometimes due to studies, work, or personal issues. A further 13.5% experienced stress always and 10.5% often, indicating that stress is a significant issue among the respondents.
14. **Stress management:** The most common method of managing stress was **talking to friends or family (34.5%)**, followed by listening to music (27.5%) and exercise/sports (15.8%). This indicates that respondents commonly depend on social support and recreational activities to manage stress.
15. **Hobbies and enjoyable activities:** **32.2%** of respondents spent time on hobbies several times a week and another 32.2% did so daily. This suggests that a majority regularly engage in activities they enjoy.
16. **Comfort discussing emotional problems:** A clear majority of **66.1%** reported that they were comfortable discussing mental or emotional problems with someone they trust. This indicates a generally positive level of openness toward trusted emotional support.

17. **Self-perception of healthy lifestyle:** **53.2%** considered themselves to have a healthy lifestyle, while 28.7% did not and 18.1% were unsure. Thus, more than half of the respondents perceived their lifestyle as healthy.
18. **Barriers to a healthy lifestyle:** **Lack of time (24.6%)** was the most commonly identified barrier, followed by lack of motivation and academic pressure at **18.7% each**. Excessive screen time was also a notable barrier at 17.5%.
19. **Areas for improvement:** **Sleep (26.9%)** was the most commonly selected area respondents wanted to improve, closely followed by **exercise (25.7%)**. Time management, diet, stress management and screen time were also identified as areas requiring improvement.
20. **Healthy lifestyle programmes:** A majority of **62.6%** supported schools and colleges conducting healthy lifestyle programmes for Generation Z students, while 15.2% were unsure and 22.2% did not support them. This indicates considerable support for institutional health and wellness initiatives.
21. **Most important healthy habit:** From the categorised open-ended responses, **Healthy Diet (16.4%)** was the most frequently identified habit, followed by **Multiple Healthy Habits (15.8%)** and Sleep (9.9%). This shows that respondents particularly recognize healthy eating and a combination of healthy practices as important for maintaining a healthy lifestyle.
22. **Suggestions for healthier living:** In Q22, **Multiple Healthy Lifestyle Suggestions (14.0%)** was the largest meaningful suggestion category. Healthy Diet/Food and Screen-Time/Mobile Reduction each accounted for **9.9%**, while Positive Attitude/Self-Motivation accounted for 9.4%. However, 35.7% provided no specific response. This indicates that respondents who gave meaningful suggestions mainly emphasized combined healthy habits, healthy food and reducing excessive mobile or screen use.

5.2 SUGGESTIONS

Based on the findings of the study, the following suggestions are recommended to promote a healthier lifestyle among Generation Z students:

1. **Promote regular physical activity**

Students should be encouraged to engage in regular exercise, walking, sports, yoga or other physical activities. Since a considerable proportion of respondents reported limited exercise, colleges can encourage simple and manageable physical activities as part of their daily routine.

2. **Encourage healthy eating habits**

Students should be encouraged to consume more fruits, vegetables, nutritious foods and balanced meals while reducing frequent consumption of fast food and junk food. Awareness programmes can highlight the importance of healthy food choices.

3. **Improve sleep habits**

Students should maintain a consistent sleep schedule and aim for adequate sleep. Since sleep was the most commonly identified area that respondents wanted to improve, students should be encouraged to avoid unnecessary late-night activities and maintain a proper sleep routine.

4. **Reduce excessive screen and mobile-phone usage**

Students should be encouraged to limit unnecessary smartphone and social-media usage, particularly before bedtime. Digital-wellness awareness programmes can help students understand the possible effects of excessive screen time on sleep and physical activity.

5. **Strengthen stress-management practices**

Students should be encouraged to adopt healthy methods of managing stress, such as talking with trusted friends or family members, exercising, listening to music, practising relaxation techniques and managing their academic workload effectively.

6. **Improve time management**

Since lack of time was identified as an important barrier to maintaining a healthy lifestyle,

students should develop better time-management practices. Proper scheduling can help them balance studies, exercise, sleep, food habits, hobbies and personal activities.

7. Encourage positive attitudes and self-motivation

Students should develop self-motivation and a positive attitude towards maintaining healthy habits. Small and realistic lifestyle changes should be encouraged rather than attempting to change all habits at once.

8. Conduct healthy lifestyle programmes in educational institutions

Schools and colleges should conduct regular programmes covering physical fitness, nutrition, sleep, stress management, mental well-being and digital-wellness practices. This is particularly relevant because a majority of respondents supported conducting healthy lifestyle programmes for Generation Z students.

9. Encourage consistency and discipline

Students should be encouraged to maintain healthy habits consistently. Developing simple daily routines involving adequate sleep, healthy food, physical activity and controlled screen time can contribute to long-term well-being.

10. Provide accessible support and awareness

Educational institutions can provide counselling, awareness sessions, fitness activities and peer-support initiatives so that students feel comfortable seeking help and discussing emotional or lifestyle-related difficulties with trusted people.

5.3 Conclusion

The study concludes that Generation Z students are aware of the importance of maintaining a healthy lifestyle, but they face several challenges in consistently following healthy practices. The findings highlight important areas such as sleep, physical activity, healthy eating, screen-time control, stress management and time management. Although many respondents recognized the importance of healthy diet and multiple healthy habits, sleep and exercise were also identified as major areas for improvement. The study further indicates that excessive screen usage, lack of time, lack of motivation and academic pressure can affect students' ability to maintain healthy lifestyle practices. Therefore, maintaining a healthy lifestyle among Generation Z requires both individual commitment and institutional support. Educational institutions can play an important role by conducting health-awareness programmes, encouraging physical activity, promoting healthy eating and sleep habits, supporting stress management, and creating awareness about responsible screen usage. Such efforts can help Generation Z students develop consistent and sustainable healthy habits and improve their overall well-being.

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[WHO India – Healthy Diet](#)
7. **Deloitte. (2025). *2025 Gen Z and Millennial Survey*.**
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QUESTIONNAIRE

Healthy Lifestyle for Generation Z Students

Instructions: Please answer the following questions honestly. The information collected will be used only for academic purposes.

Section A: General Information

1. Age:

Your answer: _____

2. Gender:

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female

3. Level of Study:

- ☐ School
- ☐ Undergraduate
- ☐ Postgraduate
- ☐ Other: _____

Section B: Daily Lifestyle

4. How many hours do you usually sleep each night?

- ☐ Less than 5 hours
- ☐ 5–6 hours
- ☐ 7–8 hours
- ☐ More than 8 hours

5. How often do you exercise or participate in physical activities?

- ☐ Never
- ☐ 1–2 days a week
- ☐ 3–4 days a week
- ☐ 5 or more days a week

6. How often do you eat fruits and vegetables?

- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Every day

7. How to often do you consume fast food or junk food?

- ☐ Never
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Daily

8. How much water do you usually drink in a day?

- ☐ Less than 1 litre
- ☐ 1–2 litres
- ☐ 2–3 litres
- ☐ More than 3 litres

Section C: Technology and Screen Time

9. How many hours do you spend on your smartphones each day?

- ☐ Less than 2 hours
- ☐ 2–4 hours
- ☐ 4–6 hours
- ☐ More than 6 hours

10. How much of your screen time is spent on social media?

- ☐ Less than 1 hour
- ☐ 1–2 hours
- ☐ 2–4 hours
- ☐ More than 4 hours

11. Do you use your phone or other devices before going to sleep?

- ☐ Always
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Never

12. Do you think excessive screen time effects your sleep or physical activity?

- ☐ Yes
 - ☐ No
 - ☐ Not sure
-

Section D: Mental and Emotional Well-being

13. How often do you feel stressed because of studies, work, or personal issues?

- ☐ Never
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Always

14. What is your most common way of managing stress?

- ☐ Exercise/sports
- ☐ Listening to music
- ☐ Talking to friends or family
- ☐ Meditation videos/using social media
- ☐ Watching videos/using social media
- ☐ Sleeping
- ☐ Other: _____

15. How often do you take time for hobbies or activities you enjoy?

- ☐ Daily
- ☐ Several times a week
- ☐ Occasionally
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

16. Do you feel comfortable discussing your mental or emotional problems with someone you trust?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Sometimes

Section E: Awareness and Healthy Choices

17. Do you consider yourself to have a healthy lifestyle?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

18. Which factor makes it most difficult for you to maintain a healthy lifestyle?

- ☐ Lack of time
- ☐ Academic pressure
- ☐ Excessive screen time
- ☐ Lack of motivation
- ☐ Cost of healthy food
- ☐ Social influence
- ☐ Other: _____

19. Which area of your lifestyle would you most like to improve?

- ☐ Diet
- ☐ Exercise
- ☐ Sleep
- ☐ Screen time
- ☐ Stress management
- ☐ Time management

20. Do you think schools and colleges should conduct programmes on healthy lifestyles for Generation Z students?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

21. In your opinion, what is the most important habit for maintaining a healthy lifestyle?

Your answer:

22. What suggestions would you give to help Generation Z students live a healthier life?

Your answer:

ANNEXURE

